

1. System status feedback

A well-designed system keeps users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within reasonable time. Status of fields, inputs, and controls don't confuse, and they have affordances for performed action.

The visibility of system status is a basic tenet of a great user experience.

- Open and continuous communication is fundamental to all relationships and build trust.
- Users informed about the system's current status can decide what to do next in order to accomplish their goals;
- Yet, they can figure out if their actions were effective or if they made a mistake.

		0	1	2	3	4	5	Comment
1	There is clear feedback when a task has been completed successfully.				✓			—
2	Progress and response notification (progress icon, transparent dialogues).			✓				—
3	Animations are purposeful, they feed back about consequences, connect action with its result, don't distract user; and happen swiftly, not delaying or slowing product down.					✓		—
4	Buttons, search, inputs, and items have affordance for (different) states or traits (like active, focus, disabled, unavailable).					✓		—
5	Cursor affordance for currently affecting action (drag, copy, click).					✓		—
Total		17						
Percentage		68 %						

2. Match between system and the real world.

Follow user mental model

The system should behave as a conscientious human. It should speak the users' language, with words, phrases, and concepts familiar to a user, rather than system-oriented terms. It also should follow the user's expectations derived from previous real-life experience.

If the system behaves like user expects it to behave, then the system is intuitive, natural, it seems familiar to the user thus used with predilection. If the system goes against user acquired experience and expectations, it's an effort to convert people to 'other' way of doing things. They may commit errors and break their flow.

- Writing, style, and interaction design demonstrates that the system knows its users and cares about them, and it decides how a digital experience makes users feel and experience a process.
- Familiarity is what makes these experiences enjoyable.

		0	1	2	3	4	5	Comment
1	The System matches the user's expectations and prior experiences with real-world systems (e.g. there are no incomprehensible, unnatural actions driven by technical constraints, like assigning person to user, filling all organization data before sending the order).							-
2	Details of the software's internal workings (that user has no control over) are not exposed to the user (both by system errors or nomenclature).							-
3	Visual code (icons, appearance of elements) matches user level of experience and expectations.							-
4	System elements look similar to user's familiar idioms (e. g. calendar view looks like calendar in other application or as in real life).							-
5	Copywriting is appropriate (level of formality) and understandable (level of jargon) to end users.							-
6	Obvious actions are performed automatically, without user prior confirmation.							-
7	Features and actions are context related (e. g. disabled action for locked layer or saving disabled for already saved changes).							-
8	System matches real world actions meaning and behaviour (e. g. delete is not the same as remove. Create is different from add or permit).							-
9	User is not redirected through screens. The seamless flow is being preserved. ...							-
Total		42						
Percentage		93 %						

3. User control and reversibility

The system provides clear messages about consequences and allow 'emergency exits' in case of user mistakes and mishitting. It clearly names functions, explaining their result and consequences.

- User feel confident to 'try out' unknown features if he is sure to reverse changes. User is not stopped in his fow by wondering what should be the next step. Allowing user recover, system encourages self-education. User is assisted by attentive and forgiving system.

		0	1	2	3	4	5	Comment
1	It is clear to users how to undo, go back and change option or cancel actions; or they are at least given a chance to confirm an irreversible action before committing (e.g. before placing an order).				✓			—
2	Pop-ups message is clear and user knows what each action means (e.g. he knows what he is cancelling or 'OKing').					✓		—
3								—
4	The product ensures that work is not lost (either by the user or site error).						✓	—
5	The product provides good feedback (e.g. progress indicators or messages) when needed (e.g. during checkout).					✓		—
Total	Actions' consequence is reflected by their appearance (e.g. OK button is green not red).	16/20						
Percentage		80 %						

4. Consistency and navigational clarity

The system allows user learn features by placing them always in the same place and provide right affordance for possible actions, follows existing standards, so that users know what to expect and how to operate the interface. It always shows precisely where the user is in the flow and what is the step back and forward. It facilitates user flow with consistent layout and consequent naming.

- Predictable and learn-able, the user relies on the interface to determine which elements are actionable.
- The user's existing expectations for how things act are fulfilled.
- It is adding to users cognitive load every time the product is forcing them to learn something new. It should be done only if absolutely necessary.

		0	1	2	3	4	5	Comment
1	The navigational scheme (e.g. menu) is easy to find, intuitive and consistent. The navigation system is broad and shallow (many items on a menu) rather than deep (many menu levels, nested items).						✓	-
2	The current user location within the system and the flow is clearly indicated (e.g. breadcrumb, highlighted menu item). User knows how to go back and where he will be driven in the next screen and how to quit.						✓	-
3	Navigation is persistent. Always at hand.						✓	-
4	Complex actions are divided into well described and logic steps. The user is aware how long will it take to accomplish a procedure and how many data he is to fill in.						✓	-
5	Users can easily get back to the Main Window or a relevant start point.						✓	-
6	Navigation choices are ordered in the most logical or task-oriented manner. Important actions are close at hand.						✓	-
7	Consistent layout across views.						✓	-
8	Affordance for primary, secondary or unwanted actions.					✓		-
9	Consequent features placement and consistent interface elements design across views.					✓		-
10	System has common, external standard, domain-specific element or features (shopping chart, log-out, history of instalments).						✓	-
11	Cross-linkage. The user doesn't have to navigate to the desired screen to make changes, but is led directly. Important content can be accessed from more than one link (multi-lateral access).						✓	-
12	Affordance for visited, modified or inactive items.					✓		-
13	Links have affordance for clicking.					✓		-
14	Control method consistency (users do not need to make numerous shifts from keyboard to mouse to keyboard).						✓	-
15	The link name matches the title of destination pages, so users know precisely when they reached the intended page.						✓	-
16	There are no redundant or similar features named differently (e.g. Submit, Save, Send), or different words, symbols or actions mean the same thing.					✓		-
17	There are no stylistic stand-offs or visual violations of established meaning (e.g. different highlight colour).						✓	-
18	User accessibility (Product navigation requires minimum of scrolling and clicking).						✓	-
Total		85						
Percentage		94 %						

5. Error prevention

Users are often distracted from the task at hand, so the system should prevent unconscious errors by offering suggestions, utilizing constraints, and being flexible. Thoughtful design is transparent and easy to understand, provides a preview, and helps users easily correct their errors. The system's ingenuity should minimize user effort by suggesting and allowing for future changes rather than forbidding and requiring all inputs filled in at once.

There are two kinds of errors that system should compel with. Slips (occur when users intend to perform one action, but end up doing another - often similar - action) and Mistakes (resulting generally from incomplete or incorrect information about the task, and user developing a mental model that doesn't match how the interface actually works).

Strategies for preventing slips are centred around gently guiding users so that they stay on the right path and have fewer chances of slipping. Assisting users by providing the needed level of precision, and encourage users to check for errors.

- Include helpful constraints to limit user choices (like for selecting days of travel).
- Offer suggestions.
- Choose good defaults.
- Format input information in a way that is easily scannable (by humans, not machines) in order to prevent mistakes.

Preventing mistakes involves understanding users’ mental models and their expectations and making designers match them.

- Gather user data to discover the specific gaps between users’ mental models and designers' mental models.
- Use standard design conventions. Each and every user that interacts with your website or application has been trained by thousands of other designers to expects common interactive elements to look and work a certain way, and error-prone conditions can arise when your website deviates from those conventions.
- Communicate affordance.
- Warn before errors are made.

		0	1	2	3	4	5	Comment
1	If no search results are returned, the system offers ideas or options for improving the query.			✓				—
2	Mishitting auto correction and auto suggestions where eligible.			✓				—
3	Confirmation before destructive actions.				✓			—
4	Data inputs clarity. Fields in data entry screens contain default values (or hints, examples or model answers to demonstrate the expected input) when appropriate and show the structure of the data and the field length. Field labels on forms clearly explain what entries are desired.						✓	—
5	Data formats follow appropriate cultural conventions (e.g. miles for UK, YYYY/MM/DD).						✓	—
6	Inputs are validated prior to submitting.						✓	—
7	A few information is requested, minimising user spelling errors.				✓			—
8	Required and optional form fields are clearly indicated.					✓		—
9	System handles duplicates (search results, users, data).						✓	—
10	When the user needs to choose between different options (such as in a dialogue box), the options are obvious.						✓	—
11	Appropriate buttons affordance for performed actions.						✓	—
Total		44						
Percentage		80 %						

6. Memory recognition ease

Showing users things they can recognize improves usability over needing to recall items from scratch because the extra context helps users retrieve information from memory. The well-designed system minimizes the user’s memory load (like making him remember information from one part of the dialogue to another or one view to another), it displays information where they are meaningful, the system facilitates making changes where information is displayed.

Whenever possible, system should remove conditions that require users to keep information in their own memory while they move from one step to another in complex, multi-step procedures. Instead, it rather displays the contextual information that users need to complete a task. System should make information and interface functions visible and easily accessible.

- Support user history and previously visited content
- Suggest users how they may use the app, rather than learn them how they are supposed to use it. Use tips that are tailored to the page that the user is visiting rather than prompting users with tutorial.
- Display information in right context, in groups or thematic clusters.
- Allow for direct manipulation rather than remembering data, navigating to other screen and recalling to modify it.

		0	1	2	3	4	5	Comment
1	Data is modifiable where it is displayed or leads to a place where it can be modified.						✓	...
2	Consistency between data entry and data display.					✓		...
3	Interrelated information, derived from computation of several dependencies, are clearly explained (e.g. price of item if depends on format, size, delivery; booking if depends on number of guests; prognosis if depends on price and time span).				✓			...
4	Product supports history (of user manipulations with a file, of operations, of search queries, last visits) or a kind of temporary storage (favourites, wish-list).	✓						...
5	GUI direct manipulation is intuitive. GUI is explained by tips, progressive disclosure and good gestural affordance. Tooltips explain features and help user understand purpose of a presented screen.			✓				...
Total		14						
Percentage		56%						

7. Flexibility and Efficiency of use

The system is designed for beginners, supports perpetual intermediates and appreciates pro users. Its focus is to fasten user flow and successful task completion. It supports learning rather than admonishing, hides advanced features from the beginner, allows for short-cuts for professionals. It facilitates probable features rather than all possible. Furthermore, it provides information gradually, facilitate discovering and logic linkage and don't overwhelm newbies with information, abbreviations and various controls.

- Speed up the interaction for expert users, provide accelerators;
- Support numerous ways of action accomplishing. Allow user choose his way of interaction.

		0	1	2	3	4	5	Comment
1	Restricted access, account creation and verification ease - yet not compromising on security.							-
2	User goals completion is clear, divided into steps, reversible and there are no lateral break-paths.							-
3	The number of screens (steps) required per user journey.							-
4	Complexity of tasks goes in pair with outcome (common and obvious tasks are easy to perform, complex result may require more sophisticated actions but users effort is awarded by valuable outcome).							-
5	Tooltips explain features and help user understand purpose of the view.							-
6	Product anticipates and prompts for the user's probable next activity (recently performed actions memory).							-
7	Appropriate labels and naming for performed actions.							-
8	Workspace memory. Product remember user settings, last location, previously opened documents.							-
9	Recurring activities. System has memory of search queries, range, filters and inputs.							-
10	The System improves on user efficiency and excels over alternative work-flow (JRL).							-
11	Introduction and system features explanation for beginners.							-
12	Performance. The system remains responsive while processing.							-
13	The system provides alternative ways of data insertion (keyboard control, mouse control, voice, touch control allows for the same efficiency).							-
14	The system supports beginners and expert users by providing different levels of explanation. Introduction and advanced features are hidden from an intermediate user.							-
15	Featuritis avoidance. It gives attention to probable rather than possible. Options arranged by the frequency and probability of usage.							-
16	Non-reversible, view changing features are hidden from careless user reach.							-
17	Customizable view and short-cuts for improving professionals work-flow.							-
18	Application performance goes with the user experience (e.g. window downloads, loading time).							-
19	Conditional, the user can defer fixing errors until later in his task flow.							-
20	Automatic insertion of formatting data (e.g. currency symbols, commas for 1000s, trailing or leading spaces). Users do not need to enter characters like £ or %.							-
21	With data entry screens, the focus is placed where the input is needed.							-
22	The product avoids advertisement or intrusive pop-ups.							-
23	The product (pages, views) suggests users what to do rather than what to avoid doing. Screens are populated with default data, giving user instant overview of screen purpose.							-
24	New or additional features are being introduced in meaningful, easy to memorize way.							-
25	Buttons and toggles have appropriate size and spacing eliminating mishitting.							-
26	Elements are not abbreviated, cropped or hidden when there is enough real estate screen.							-
27	Cropped, hidden, abbreviated elements have affordance for revealing.							-
28	Empty fields are ignored (if not required).							-
Total		72						
Percentage		51 %						

8. Simplicity and information architecture

The system provides the user with the exact information that is needed and in the right place. Every extra piece of information in a dialogue competes with the relevant units of information, diminishes their relative visibility and is simply distracting noise.

- Decorations don't add anything to accomplishing of user goals;
- Information should be hierarchized and distractors free.

		0	1	2	3	4	5	Comment
1	Related information and functions are clustered together.							-
2	The information provided is relevant, not superfluous by amount and distracting by layout.							-
3	Logic paging and information divided into chunks.							-
4	Abbreviations are limited (in labels or tables). Tables fit into screen and remain legible.							-
5	Precise drilling down the information and filtering.							-
6	Text and content are legible with good typography and visual contrast.							-
7	Grammar errors and spelling mistakes proof.							-
8	The content is up to date.							-
9	Copywriting is concise, with no needless instructions, welcome notes, or aggressive advertisement boasting.							-
10	Context uses intuitive headlines structure (H1-H6, body).							-
11	The content follows an inverted pyramid structure (text starts with a conclusion, followed by the most important supporting information and then giving the background).							-
12	The layout helps focus attention on work flow. Concise information structure prepared for scannability (content has highlighted hyperlinks, meaningful sub-headings, bulleted lists and summary/call to action).							-
13	Pop-ups and dialogue boxes with settings appear in obvious place, fit to page and aren't cropped.							-
14	The visuals (graphics or photos) support primary goals of users or the company (the message is conveyed by consistent images look and feel, there are no superfluous and meaningless graphics).							-
Total		44						
Percentage		63 %						

9. Help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors

If the design fails, and the user is about to commit an error, the last instance to prevent it is an error message. The Error message, in purpose to be efficient, is expressed in plain language (no codes), precisely indicating the problem, and constructively suggesting the solution.

- Diligently leads user to error causes.
- Suggest solution and direct user to erroneous place.
- Allow for fixing error directly in the pop-up.
- Make sure errors are corrected before proceeding.
- Provide undo feature.

		0	1	2	3	4	5	Comment
1	Easy errors' correction by focus, proposing solutions or link where to modify error causes.	✓	□	□	□	□	□	...
2	Error messages are concise, written in easy to understand language and non-derisory tone and do not blame the user for the error.	□	□	□	□	□	✓	...
3	Errors are clear, easily identifiable and appear in appropriate location (e.g. adjacent to data entry field, adjacent to form, etc.). Not erasing already inserted correct values	□	□	□	□	□	✓	...
4	Important instructions remain on the screen while needed, and there are no hasty time-outs requiring the user to hasten their action.	□	□	□	□	□	✓	...
5	More details about error messages can be accessed when required. Error messages describe what's occurred and what user action is necessary.	✓	□	□	□	□	□	...
6	Undo feature reversing destructive actions.	✓	□	□	□	□	□	...
Total		15						
Percentage		50%						

10. Help and documentation

User assistance is presented at appropriate times in the interaction, focused on the user's task, lists concrete steps to be carried out, and not too large in volume. The user should be aware where to search for helpful information and efficiently find the answer.

- Help should focus on problem solving, not on user introduction.

		0	1	2	3	4	5	Comment
1	Help is context related. User can find out more about a feature in his task flow.	✓	□	□	□	□	□	...
2	Help is easy to search. Help is arranged into cases (user tasks), user can easily sieve through threads.	✓	□	□	□	□	□	...
3	Accessing online help does not impede users (i.e. they can resume work where they left off after accessing help).	□	□	□	□	□	✓	...
4	Users can get further help (e.g. telephone or email address).	□	□	□	□	□	✓	...
5	Help provides step-by-step instructions (in the form of FAQ) to help users carry out the most important tasks.	✓	□	□	□	□	□	...
6	The product has customized error pages providing alternatives and facilitating user flow rather than leading him back.	✓	□	□	□	□	□	...
Total		10						
Percentage		33 %						

User Interface Usability Audit

Product Name	Researcher Name	...	Viktoriia Sokyrko
	Age	...	47
Date	Occupation	...	Musician

How to use the template

Take most common business use scenarios for your product. As researcher go through the scenarios and then evaluate the product upon 10 universal UX Heuristics. Ask two other researchers to do the same. Each criterion is followed by a short description of ideal user experience. Each (detailed) point of criteria can be scored in a six-point scale (0–5) where 5 means ideal experience:



Score 5 — where the user is meaningfully guided through task flow and don't waste any time on checking, pondering what a control means or trying it out.



Score 0 — means no positive user experience, and functioning that is against the user mental model makes the user fail in his goals. The user feels blamed by the application, and has to memorize many settings across screens and is prone to errors with input and controls that don't facilitate but mercifully allow a user to submit values.



Score 3 — is positive but demands on improvements. The User can eventually accomplish his task, but there are better alternatives.

Each section, corresponding to one heuristic, presents detailed questions to be answered. Sometimes the product doesn't have features corresponding to the questions or any such wasn't observed during scenario execution. In such case default score is 3, or decide with your team to omit the detailed question.

**You can also go with a high level estimation and simply assign one score for each section, ignoring questions. In this way you will get a ballpark value, that you don't have to express as percentage.*

The end result is the average taken from all questions from a section and expressed in a percentage, where 100% means all 5s.